and the G-1 and an administrative team with the Dy and AAG, to look after the operational and administrative aspects of the raising, respectively, with the AQ as the fulcrum. Of course, the overall responsibility would remain mine, but it would free me from mundane housekeeping chores and decisions. Once the overall strategy had been discussed and formalized, then it was just a matter of coordination. I could then spend as much time in the forward area to bring the Brigade up to speed.

The operational area assigned to the Brigade was in the HAA of the Tawang sector, which had six sub-sectors. Prior to the raising of 71 Infantry Division, the entire sector was looked after by 5 Mountain Division alone. The other Division of the Corps, 21 Mountain Division, was the reserve. The drawback of the earlier deployment was that 5 Mountain Division did not have any reserves of its own and therefore, 21 Mountain Division would get committed early on. Therefore, the requirement of another Division, each with its own reserves. The Tawang sector was thus divided between the two Divisions, with the three Western sub-sectors remaining with 5 Mountain Division, and the three Eastern sub-sectors going to 71 Infantry Division. In this arrangement, 106 Infantry Brigade was given the responsibility of defending the Landa Ridge sub-sector, adjoining 5 Mountain Division, with its Battalions echeloned one behind the other. There was one Battalion right up front at Pt 4720, Landa North, another midway through the ridge, Landa Centre, and the third (as yet notional) Battalion further down the ridge at C III, or Landa South, along with the Brigade HQ. The HQ of the second Brigade was also on the same ridge, sandwiched between Landa North and South, with the tactical HQ of the Division at the base of the ridge at C I. The third and Eastern-most sub-sector was an ad hoc sub-sector looked after by the Dy Cdr of one of the Brigades,

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